

Topic: Life in Makkah

Migration to Abyssinia

Q (a) Give an account of the migration of the early Muslims to Abyssinia. [10]

Answer Structure

Para 1	Para 2	Para 3
- Reference of Persecution. - Increase in Persecution. 1st Batch. (Rajab, 5th Year of Prophethood. - A rumor and return of some members.	2nd Batch (Shawwal, 5th Year of Prophethood) - Quraysh delegate to ask Muslims' expulsion. - Bribery and Manipulation.	- Quraysh and Muslims in courtroom of Negus. - Jafar's speech and recitation of Surah Maryam. - Negus' verdict.

Answer

- ☐ 2 Years of horrible persecution started right after open preaching.
- ☐ Slaves and poor were soft targets.
- ☐ Some Muslims felt that they might not resist this torture and this could affect their faith and life. Allah (SWT) allowed Muslims to migrate:
 - 📖 "...O you servants of Mine who believe, have fear of your Lord. A good end awaits those who did good in this world and Allah's earth is spacious" [39:10]
- ☐ In the month of Rajab, 5th Year of Prophethood, 12 men and 4 women left for Abyssinia.
- ☐ Some Notables:
 - ❖ **Uthman bin Affan** (RA) and his wife **Ruqayya** (RA)
 - ❖ **Abdul Rehman bin Auf** (RA)
 - ❖ **Zubair bin Awwam** (RA)
 - ❖ **Umm-e-Salma** (RA).
- ☐ They used 2 vessels, left from the port of Shu'aibah situated nearby Jeddah.
- ☐ Quraysh sent some men to stop them but they had already left.
- ☐ **As'hamah** the king of Abyssinia (whose title was Negus) was a very just ruler. He welcomed Muslims and allowed them to stay in Abyssinia as long as they want.
- ☐ Incident of recitation of Surah Najam and leaders of Quraysh prostrating.
- ☐ Some of the member of first batch returned after listening to a rumor that whole Makkah has embraced Islam. But upon return they found out that news was untrue. Now situation got worse for them.
- ☐ In the same year Prophet (PBUH) allowed Muslims to migrate to Abyssinia once again.
- ☐ As people had heard about nice treatment and justice of Negus, this time number rose to 101. 83 men and 19/18 women migrated.
- ☐ Some notables:
 - ❖ **Jafar bin Abu Talib** (RA) and his wife **Asma** (RA)
 - ❖ **Umm-e-Habiba bint Abu Sufyan** (RA)
 - ❖ **Abdullah bin Masud** (RA).
- ☐ Quraysh sent **Amr bin Aas** and **Abdullah bin Abu Rabi'ah** to ask their expulsion. They brought precious gifts to bribe the ministers and counselors of Negus.
- ☐ Quraysh claimed:
 - Some of them are slaves and according to the tradition of Arab, they should be returned to their masters.
 - They are infidels as they abandoned the religion of forefathers.



- They have destroyed Makkah society by making blood relatives fight and hate each other.
- ☐ In return, Jafar bin Abu Talib (RA) delivered a speech in which he gave a glimpse of period of illiteracy and how Prophet's (PBUH) teachings transformed believers into better human beings. He destroyed all false claims of Quraysh.
- ☐ Quraysh then used another trick and asked Negus to inquire Muslims' belief about Jesus Christ in order to create misunderstanding between Muslims and Negus (who was a Christian). Hazrat Jafar (RA) recited Surah Maryam and asserted Islamic belief about Jesus. Negus replied:
 - 📖 "Jesus was nothing more than what Jafar said about him"
 Negus also about Quranic verses that were recited in front of him:
 - 📖 "These verses and Bible are rays of the same Light"
- ☐ Quraysh delegate had to return unsuccessful and Muslims were allowed to stay in Abyssinia with full protection. They lived peacefully until they joined Muslims in Madinah.

Q (b) Why did the people of Makkah pursue Muslims? [04]

Answer

- ☐ This migration challenged Quraysh's authority. Quraysh attempted to stop them but they could not get them.
- ☐ Quraysh could not see Muslims living in peace and protection.
- ☐ As guardians and caretakers of Makkah Quraysh had influence and respect across the Arab and effortless earnings by pilgrims and other sources was cherry on top. They feared that Islam would spread further if Muslims were given chance to live a peaceful and tension free life. That would eventually finish Quraysh's Spiritual, Political and Economic superiority over Arab.

Q (b) What was the importance of making this migration at that time? [4]

Q (b) What was the significance of this migration for the early Muslim community? [04]

Answer

- ☐ Muslims could flee Quraysh's persecution that had hindered them from practicing their religion freely.
- ☐ Muslims got the chance to show case the power of Islamic morals and teachings in order to inspire people of Abyssinia and spread Islam internationally.
- ☐ Just because of this migration Negus of Abyssinia accepted Islam.
- ☐ Muslims tested their diplomatic efforts as they halted Makkah's effort when they requested Negus to expel Muslims back to Makkah. This was a huge diplomatic victory of Islam and Muslims that helped him further in their international relations.

